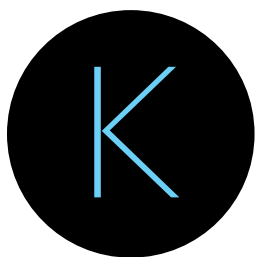




BY PAWAN MUNJAL

The Five Ps that will Take India Forward

India's cultural ethos combined with its modern outlook and expertise is powering it on the superhighway to development



RISHNAM NIYAMAM HARAYAH *suparna apo wasana divam uttapanti*” broadly interpreted as “along the dark course, tawny well-feathered (birds or flames), clothing themselves in the waters, fly up towards heaven” by Maharshi Dayanand, these verses from the Rig Veda allude to the earliest spacecraft known to man. Our rich cultural heritage has unfailingly mesmerised us with wondrous legends

that not only inspire our modern world but will also spur future generations with foresight and sagacity.

Today, India stands at the threshold of achieving that destiny—to be among the best in the world—in another decade or so. Our young population and its aspirations are radically distinct. Already home to more than 100 unicorns and many fintechs that are revolutionising our lives, we are thriving to solve what economists would call “beyond the horizon” problems with our ingenuity and hardwired instincts. As we celebrate “Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav”, ready to usher in our golden century of independence in 2047, our collective vision—elucidated as India 2.0 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi—is rolling

out a well-defined blueprint for the country to achieve its true potential. Inspired by the vision of AatmaNirbharBharat, it seeks cohesive and balanced progress in terms of ‘People, Planet and Prosperity’—commonly known as the UN sustainable development goals.

People power: The biggest strength of our country comes from its vibrant people—who are hard-working and resilient, and known around the world for it. As the world ages rapidly, a young India is expected to shoulder the responsibility of taking economic growth forward with its immense talent. Experts say that if we utilise our huge demographic dividend productively, our GDP will jump from the current \$3 trillion to \$9 trillion by 2030 and \$40 trillion by 2047. This dividend is already manifesting in innovation, entrepreneurship, social revolution and widespread tech adoption.

It is impressive to note the foresight of our people and the government to capture this once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. The plans, policies and investments in universal healthcare, especially to reduce infant and mother mortality, visionary education policies and increasing emancipation of women to participate in jobs and family welfare will go a long way in achieving this vision. It is also delightful to watch the competition among states to attract investments, but they must also support the central government in dealing with issues like migration, ageing, skilling and urbanisation. As we proudly say that every sixth person on Earth is an Indian, let’s hope that every second productive talent is an Indian in another decade or so.

Planet Earth: We live in a country that culturally reveres mother nature and all its living beings, having inscribed “*Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*,” or “the whole world is a family” in its